

Voluntary Report – Voluntary - Public Distribution

Date: February 03, 2025

Report Number: NL2025-0002

Report Name: Overview of the Market of Industrial Hemp in the Netherlands and Its Potential as Bio-based Material

Country: Netherlands

Post: The Hague

Report Category: Trade Policy Monitoring, Oilseeds and Products, Agricultural Situation, Agriculture in the Economy

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Report Highlights:

This report describes the current trends and developments of the industrial hemp sector in the Netherlands. Key highlight include the Netherlands' National Approach Biobased Building, a strategy for construction through which it aims to have 30 percent of all newly built houses and utility buildings constructed with at least 30 percent bio-based construction materials by 2030. Hemp can play a role in this ambition. The report further provides an overview of the Dutch hemp market, and may be read as update to NL2020-0015 An Overview of the Dutch Hemp Market.

1. Hemp Cultivation and Trade in the Netherlands

Cultivation of hemp, a fiber crop, has been making its comeback in the Netherlands since the 1990s.¹ Up until 2012, the European Union (EU) Common Agricultural Policy provided crop-specific support for growing hemp (and another well-known fiber crop, flax). After this stopped,² the fiber crops were eligible for one-time only payments for two subsequent years by the Dutch government ((\$309 and \$278/ha, in 2013 and 2014 respectively³). These subsidies were meant so that farmers would keep hemp in their crop plan, given attractively high grain prices those seasons. This way, also the hemp and flax processing industry would remain in business. This approach seemed to have had its effect, although hemp's cultivated area did not grow any further in subsequent years. However, in 2023 a new Dutch approach was published for fiber crops, aimed at stimulating the sustainable construction material production chain. Not only are hemp and flax eligible for subsidies, but also straw and less-known fiber crops such as elephant grass (*miscanthus*).

Because of the new incentive, hemp production is estimated to be increasing in the Netherlands (Figure 1). It grew from 1,976 hectares in 2023 to an estimated 3,440 hectares in 2024, an increase of 74 percent. The predicted harvest for 2024 shows an increase of an estimated 84 percent, from 13,640 tons to an estimated 25,120 tons in 2024.

The Netherlands' cultivated area of hemp is 6.9 percent of the European Union (EU) total in 2023 (the latter being 28,830 hectare in 2023)⁴, which makes it the third largest area cultivated with hemp in the European Union (EU). The number one is France (19,410 hectares), and two is Germany (2,900 hectares). The 2022 global hemp production was estimated at 275,000 tons⁵; in that year, the EU production was determined at 177,430 tons (declining to 162,240 in 2023), meaning that the EU was responsible for over half of the world's recorded production in 2022. It is of note that according to the European Industrial Hemp Association, the actual cultivated EU area might be higher due to underreporting.⁶

The Netherlands imported \$81,540 worth of industrial (fiber) hemp (HS code: 5302⁷) in 2023, importing the most from Germany (\$46,004), and after that from the United States (\$12,632)). Dutch industrial (fiber) hemp exports (HS code: 5302) were valued at \$37.6 million, and with that, it is the largest

¹ <https://www.wur.nl/nl/onderzoek-resultaten/onderzoeksinstituten/food-biobased-research/show-fbr/aan-de-slag-met-vezelhennep-handboek-voor-boer-en-gehele-keten.htm>

² <https://www.akkervijzer.nl/artikel/97299-300-euro-voor-telers-van-vlas-en-hennep/> and <https://www.nieuweoogst.nl/nieuws/2014/02/18/vezelgewassen-krijgen-270-euro-subsidie>

³ 1 USD = 0.97 EUR, where converted from euro to U.S. dollar

⁴ <https://ec.europa.eu/eurostat/databrowser/bookmark/77d65765-39b8-4745-a19d-ffea1c1353f3?lang=en>

⁵ <https://unctad.org/news/hemp-versatility-and-sustainability-offer-huge-opportunities-developing-countries>

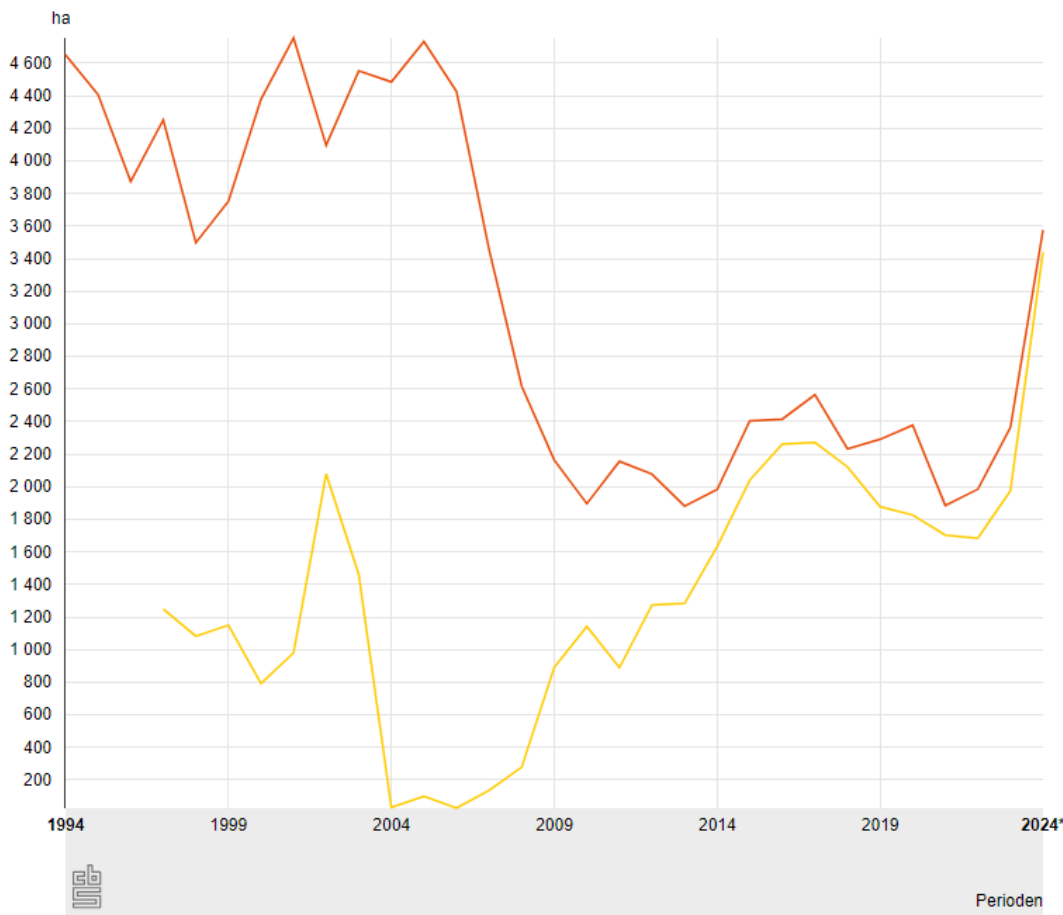
⁶ https://agriculture.ec.europa.eu/system/files/2023-06/cdg-agricultural-markets-2023-05-17-minutes_en.pdf

⁷ HS codes: 5302 10 True hemp (*Cannabis sativica* L.) Raw or setted, and 5302 90 True hemp (*Cannabis sativica* L.), processed but not spun; tow and waste of true hemp. For more information on HS codes and EU CN codes, see Section VI and VII of the GAIN report **Error! Hyperlink reference not valid..**

industrial (fiber) hemp export country in the world in terms of value, responsible for 30 percent of worldwide industrial (fiber) hemp exports. The main export countries were Germany (\$18.2 million), Italy (\$8.2 million), and Spain (\$3.5 million) in 2023. Of these exports, 75 percent was processed industrial (fiber) hemp, and 25 percent was raw or retted industrial (fiber) hemp. No Dutch exports to the United States were recorded for that year. Vice versa, U.S. industrial (fiber) hemp exports (HS code: 5302) to the Netherlands were valued at \$3.3 million in 2023.

The production of another fiber crop, flax, is also picking up as it falls under the same subsidy rules. Although it was grown on a rather constant area for five years (deviating between 3-7 percent), starting 2023 there is a large uptick visible (see Figure 1).

Figure 1. Cultivated Area Hemp (yellow, bottom line) and Flax (orange, upper line) in the Netherlands from 1994-2024 (2024 is estimated)*



Source: <https://opendata.cbs.nl/#/CBS/nl/dataset/85636NED/line?dl=B0466>

2. Hemp: Cultivation of a Sustainable Crop

It is believed that hemp cultivation in Europe started some 2000 years ago, with the crop deriving from central Asia or south Asia.⁸ Already in ancient history, hemp had many uses. Nowadays, these uses are still recognized, but also the environmental benefits of the hemp crop have been put in the spotlight. It is seen as excellent rotational crop, does not require many inputs, can improve soil (e.g., because of its deep rooting system), and can capture a high amount of carbon,⁹ estimated at 9-15 tons CO₂ per hectare¹⁰. Apart from that, the production is seen as rather straightforward, not hindered by much weeds or diseases, needing little fertilizer, and the crop growing quickly (with a growing season between May-August). On the other hand, the harvesting and processing of hemp requires highly specialized equipment.¹¹ Growers therefore are also highly specialized, often overseeing the whole production chain, from cultivation to end product.

Given the proximity of the Netherlands to its neighboring countries Belgium and Germany, there tends to be also cross-border cooperation within this specialized production chain. In the Netherlands, there are two large processing facilities, which are located in the province of Groningen:

Dun Agro Hemp Group has been active in the hemp industry for over 25 years. Its activities cover the entire production process: from agriculture to primary processing, and the production of end-products for the food sector (food ingredients, such as hemp seed oil, and food supplements), and fiber sector. The company has developed its own technologies and innovations. It has an expansive construction branch with hempcrete, insulation materials, and even prefab hemp houses. It also produces noise barriers. In addition to hemp fiber, the company also produces hemp wood, animal bedding, animal feed supplements (leaf and seed), hemp pellets, and hemp fertilizer.

HempFlax was founded in 1993, and the company grows its crops and produces its products in the Netherlands, Germany and Romania. The hemp is processed into animal bedding, construction materials, food supplements, horticultural products, and industrial application such as hemp pellets and non-wovens. HempFlax also supplies genetics such as hemp seeds.

Since 2020, the company **GreenInclusive** in the province of Friesland, also started hemp production and processing. Their production is geared towards biobased (construction) materials. For more information, see subchapter 4.¹²

⁸ <https://www.sciencedirect.com/science/article/pii/S1433831922000129>

⁹ See e.g. <https://www.mdpi.com/2071-1050/15/8/6457>

¹⁰ https://agriculture.ec.europa.eu/farming/crop-productions-and-plant-based-products/hemp_en

¹¹ <https://www.boerenbusiness.nl/akkerbouw/artikel/10897956/waarom-groeit-teelt-van-vezelhennep-niet-explosief>

¹² <https://www.melkvanhetnoorden.nl/melken-voeren/friese-hennepketen-transitie-met-serieus-verdienmodel/>

3. Hemp Eligible for Support under EU Common Agricultural Policy, as Environmental Activity

In the Netherlands, the use of hemp qualifies for basic support under the EU Common Agricultural Policy (CAP). The requirements are outlined by the Netherlands Enterprise Agency (known in Dutch under its abbreviation [RVO](#)). For 2025, the crop must be both sown and harvested before a certain date, and only for authorized hemp cultivars, as [published by RVO](#).¹³

Additionally, growing hemp can be an eco-activity under the EU Common Agricultural Policy. Each EU country has the freedom to determine its own eco-activities, which overall should establish “farming practices that contribute to EU environmental and climate goals”¹⁴. In the Netherlands, all eco-activities conducted by a farmer are scored and count towards a final tiered status (bronze, silver or gold). The subsidy increases with each tier. As eco-activity, hemp falls both under the category “fiber crop” as well as “resting crop”.¹⁵

4. Stimulating a Market for Bio-based Materials in the Netherlands through Plans and Subsidies

The Netherlands has a [National Program Circular Economy](#) with various agendas, which is set to run from 2023-2030. The goal of this program is to contribute to the Netherlands being “climate neutral, reducing the use of fossil sources and being circular” by 2050. One of the ways it wants to reach this goal, is by substituting raw materials by, among others, “high-quality bio-based raw materials”.¹⁶ The Dutch government is planning to draft a bio-resources strategy, aimed at increasing the availability and optimizing the use of bio-resources.¹⁷

The Dutch ‘National Approach Biobased Building’

A plan is already in existence aimed at stimulating the use of bio-resources within construction called the [National Approach Biobased Building](#) (known in Dutch under its acronym NABB). Due to the multidisciplinary effects of the NABB, it is a collaboration between four ministries, among them the Ministry of Agriculture, Fisheries, Food Security, and Nature.¹⁸ The current share of the Dutch biobased construction material market is estimated at 0.1 percent, and specifically for wood at 2 percent, based on their weight within all construction materials¹⁹ (which, given the relatively lighter weight of for instance biobased insulation materials, might have its limitations as determining parameter). NABB’s mission is to set up “a robust and independent market for the cultivation, processing, and application of bio-based

¹³ See <https://www.rvo.nl/onderwerpen/glb-2025/hennep>

¹⁴ https://agriculture.ec.europa.eu/common-agricultural-policy/income-support/eco-schemes_en

¹⁵ <https://www.rvo.nl/onderwerpen/mest/rustgewassen>

¹⁶ <https://www.nederlandcirculairin2050.nl/nationaal-programma-circulaire-economie/algemene-maatregelen>

¹⁷ https://www.tweedekamer.nl/kamerstukken/brieven_regering/detail?id=2024D51833&did=2024D51833

¹⁸ <https://www.rijksoverheid.nl/documenten/rapporten/2023/11/08/nationale-aanpak-biobased-bouwen>, p. 7.

¹⁹ <https://buildingbalance.eu/nationale-aanpak-biobased-bouwen/>

raw materials in construction”.²⁰ The main organization executing the NABB is [Building Balance](https://buildingbalance.eu/nationale-aanpak-biobased-bouwen/), helping to accomplish that:²¹

- At least 30 percent of newly built houses will have been constructed with 30 percent biobased materials (or more);
- At least 30 percent of the isolation (for increasing the sustainability of houses) is done with biobased materials;
- At least 30 percent of the materials for utility buildings will be biobased.

The NABB is split in two phases; one for building value chains for bio-based construction materials from 2023-2025, with a subsidy of \$25.8 million; the next is expansion of the market from 2025-2030, with a subsidy of \$180 million.²² Farmers growing fiber crops such as hemp, flax, straw, miscanthus, but also materials such as wood and cork, are eligible to participate. Construction materials made from hemp include blown-in insulation, insulation boards or mats, wall and ceiling systems, and blocks.²³ Even hemp flooring is a possibility.²⁴

To specifically stimulate fiber crops, the government made \$24 million available for 2024-2026.²⁵ According to commissioned research, this money is best returned through carbon certificates,²⁶ for which a system will be developed.²⁷ This is now piloted as “Dutch construction stored carbon credits”,²⁸ which may be traded through an organization, the [National Green Fund](https://nationalgreenfund.nl/). Around 13,000-17,000 credits may be issued, with a valuation of between \$77-\$97 per credit. Farmers who intend to grow a fiber crop that will end up as construction material, can respond to annual tenders. In 2024, \$1.2 million was made available.²⁹

To reach all goals of the NABB, the government estimates it needs 25 production chains of farmers, processors, and constructors; a cultivated area of 50,000 hectare for fiber crops; a processing capacity of 400,000 tons of fiber per year; at minimum 20 combinations matching the fiber crop to an end product; and at least 30 biobased building concepts. Biobased building material is defined as material that is at least 70 percent renewable mass, according to standard EN16575:2014.³⁰

²⁰ <https://buildingbalance.eu/nationale-aanpak-biobased-bouwen/>

²¹ <https://www.volkshuisvestingnederland.nl/onderwerpen/circulair-en-industrieel-bouwen/documenten/publicaties/2023/11/07/nationale-aanpak-biobased-bouwen>

²² <https://www.rijksoverheid.nl/actueel/nieuws/2023/11/08/200-miljoen-voor-grootschalige-aanpak-biobased-bouwen>

²³ https://www.abnamro.nl/nl/media/rapport-vezelrijke-verduurzaming_tcm16-203727.pdf

²⁴ See for instance <https://hempwood.com/>

²⁵ <https://www.tweedekamer.nl/kamerstukken/detail?id=2024D38238&did=2024D38238>

²⁶ <https://www.boerderij.nl/nationaal-groenfonds-stimulans-teelt-vezelgewassen-voor-de-bouw>, and nieuw-groen.nl/wp-content/uploads/Rapport-Marktonderzoek-Nederlandse-carbon-credits-Nieuw-Groen-2024-DEF.pdf

²⁷ <https://buildingbalance.eu/nationale-aanpak-biobased-bouwen/>

²⁸ 1 USD = 0.97 EUR, <https://www.internetconsultatie.nl/vezelteelten/b1>

²⁹ <https://buildingbalance.eu/actueel/extra-inkomsten-voor-agrariers-die-gewassen-telen-voor-de-bouw/>

³⁰ <https://www.volkshuisvestingnederland.nl/onderwerpen/circulair-en-industrieel-bouwen/documenten/publicaties/2023/11/07/nationale-aanpak-biobased-bouwen>, p. 16-17.

Prior to this, there were already several private sector initiatives in place, with similar aims:

- [GreenInclusive](#), which certified the hemp growing and processing process, offers hemp growers a CO₂ bonus. The results will later be traded as carbon certificates through [Stichting Nationale Koolstofmarkt](#)³¹;
- Construction company Heijmans worked together with GreenInclusive, purchasing the construction materials from the cultivation of hemp grown on 6.5 hectare³².

Subsidies for Home-Owners

Homeowners in the Netherlands are also actively encouraged to make their house more sustainable. This is relevant for bio-based materials, for instance since home-owners are offered subsidies for isolation with extra incentives for bio-based isolation materials.³³ The latter has been made possible through the National Approach Bio-based Materials (NABB).³⁴ For private home owners, this is financed through the [ISDE](#) subsidy (funded with \$619 million, also applies for other energy saving measures), and for private apartment owners through the [SVVE](#) subsidy (funded with \$50 million, id). Subsidies range from an additional \$1 to \$6 per m² of biobased isolation materials, on top of a base subsidy. For hemp, one activity that qualifies is “insulating blankets made of hemp or flax”.³⁵

Environmental Performance Requirement Shaping the Landscape for Biobased Materials

Additionally, the Netherlands is working on sharpening its “environmental performance” requirement, a number used to express the environmental performance of a building. The new government is investigating to what degree the adjustment will take place,³⁶ but a requirement already applies for newly built houses and offices. Simply put, building materials are valued and weighed for their environmental impact, and overall, the “environmental performance” of a building needs to remain under a specific threshold. A role for further lowering the number is seen here for biobased or renewable construction materials, such as hemp. Instruments that help showcase the environmental impact of construction material, are for instance EPD’s – Environmental Product Declarations, mandatory declarations that come with a construction material. These show a product’s impact on the environment. They will fulfill an (increasingly) important role in light of the [Construction Products Regulation](#) (CPR) in the European Union.

³¹ <https://www.boerderij.nl/carbon-credits-als-bonus-voor-telers-van-vezelhennepe>

³² [Bouwonderneming Heijmans start proef rond teelt vezelhennepe - Boerderij](#)

³³ <https://www.rvo.nl/subsidies-financiering/isde/woningeigenaren/isolatiemaatregelen#extra-subsidie-voor-milieuvriendelijk-isolatiemateriaal>

³⁴ <https://buildingbalance.eu/actueel/per-1-januari-extra-subsidie-voor-biobased-isolatiemateriaal/>

³⁵ <https://buildingbalance.eu/actueel/per-1-januari-extra-subsidie-voor-biobased-isolatiemateriaal/>

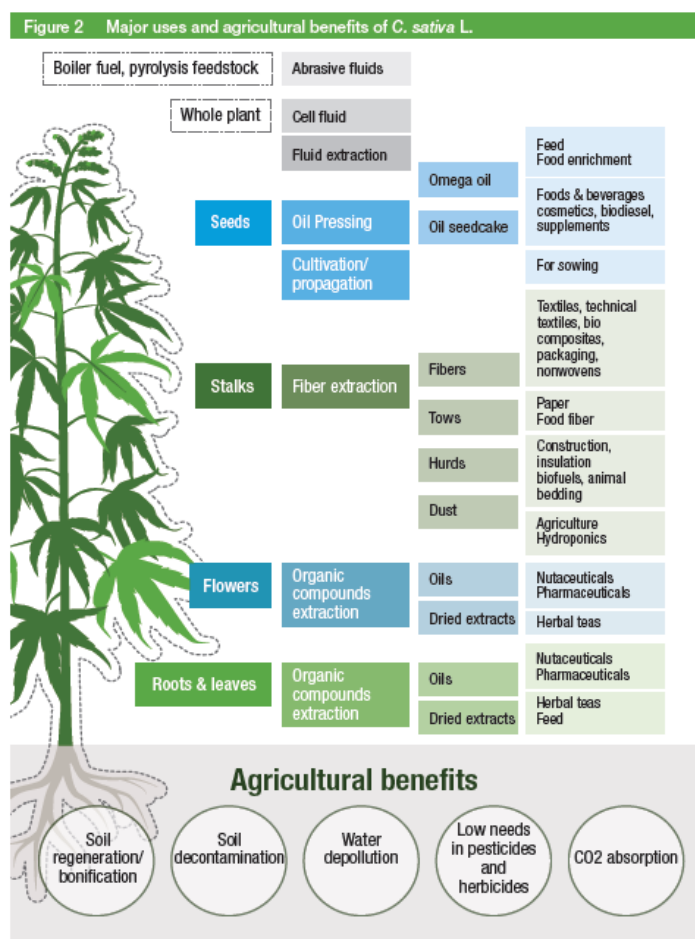
³⁶ <https://www.lbpsight.nl/artikelen/mpg-aanscherping-per-1-juli-2025-wat-verandert-wel-en-wat-niet/>

5. Hemp Applications

Next to the increased interest for hemp as raw material for construction materials, hemp cultivars have traditionally been grown for many other uses (Figure 2). Hemp is grown as a regular production crop for both its fiber and seeds. The fiber has historically been used for the production of textiles, and the husk is used as animal bedding or for pellets. The food industry showcases diverse uses, such as hemp seeds, oils (hemp seeds), tea (hemp leaves), and in food supplements or as essential oil. The cosmetic industry also increasingly has been adding hemp to its products. There are lesser-known applications such as paper (from hemp pulp), and even as plastic. Lastly, there is biochar (carbon-rich material used to improve soil).³⁷

European Union law, like the US Farm Bill³⁸, legally defines (fiber) hemp for cultivation, as any hemp cultivar containing no more than 0.3 percent THC.³⁹ This therefore also directly applies to hemp cultivation and all its products in the Netherlands.

Figure 2. The Diverse Uses of the Hemp Plant



Source: https://unctad.org/system/files/official-document/ditccom2022d1_en.pdf, p. 14

Source: Author, based on information derived from <http://www.multihemp.eu>, <http://www.fibratp7.net> and <http://www.ihat.org.au>.

³⁷ https://agriculture.ec.europa.eu/farming/crop-productions-and-plant-based-products/hemp_en

³⁸ <https://www.fda.gov/news-events/congressional-testimony/hemp-production-and-2018-farm-bill-07252019>

³⁹ <https://www.fda.gov/news-events/congressional-testimony/hemp-production-and-2018-farm-bill-07252019>

Sowing Seeds

There is no comprehensive data on the size of the industry of hemp sowing seeds, nor on its precise exports and imports. Dutch seed companies are partnering with the Dutch Wageningen University and Research (WUR) in a hemp cultivation program, and together introduced the cultivar Chameleon, which were later replaced by Marchant, Marcello, and Ivory,⁴⁰ All are on the list of approved hemp cultivars for sowing under the Common Agricultural Policy.⁴¹ Other companies, such as HempFlax, offer genetics and cultivation products.

Hemp Seeds (Food)

Hemp seeds have a favorable nutritional profile, providing some minerals.⁴² The Netherlands exported \$6.0 million worth of hemp seeds in 2023, with imports fluctuating substantially between years (reported as HS code: 12079991, hemp seeds whether or not broken (excluding for sowing)), see Table 2 and 3 in the appendix. Exports valued \$17.6 million in 2023, with Germany, the United Kingdom, Spain, Belgium and Italy being its main export partners.

The European Industrial Hemp Association conducted research into how hemp seed is used in the European Union, shown in the figure below for 2018. Most hemp seeds were used as is, others as press cake (being turned into protein flour and feed, mainly), and another part is turned into oil (Figure 3). The latter can also be purchased in Netherlands, for instance in organic retail stores, to be used as food ingredient. Hemp protein is also available in retail, for instance as protein powder, or found as functional ingredient in (vegetarian) nutrition.⁴³

Hemp seeds and their products are subject to [EU regulation 2023/915](#), setting maximum THC levels at 3.0 mg/kg for hemp seeds, including ground hemp seeds and defatted hemp seed, and 7.5 mg/kg for hemp seed oil.

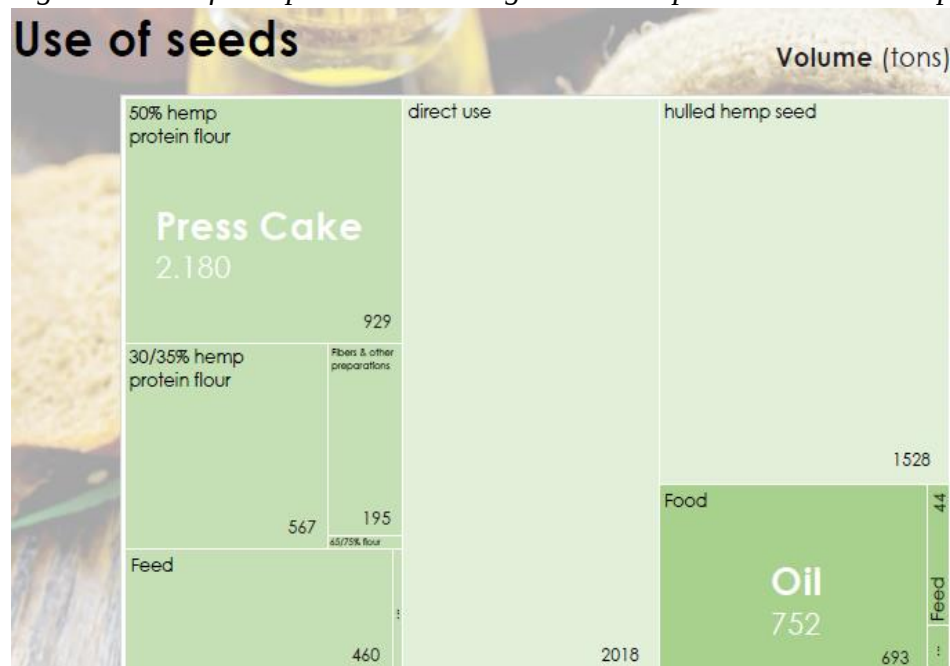
⁴⁰ <https://www.vandintersemo.nl/nl/overige-gewassen>

⁴¹ <https://www.rvo.nl/onderwerpen/glb-2024/hennep>

⁴² <https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC7400098/>

⁴³ <https://www.foodnavigator.com/Article/2024/03/14/hemp-the-next-functional-food-in-vegetarian-nutrition/>

Figure 3. Use of Hemp Seeds according to the European Industrial Hemp Association (EIHA), 2018



Source: <https://eiha.org/wp-content/uploads/2020/10/2018-Hemp-agri-report.pdf>

Food Supplements Containing CBD

Cannabidiol (CBD) is a natural component, a phytocannabinoid, found in hemp. It has no psychoactive effects. Food supplements with this ingredient have grown in popularity in recent years. However, upon a decision of the European Food Safety Authority (EFSA), CBD is considered a novel food as defined in EU Regulation 2015/2283.⁴⁴ Moreover, EFSA determined data gaps on the health effects of CBD in relation to certain domains, calling for a so-called ‘stop the clock’. This means that the data gaps need to be filled first in order for the EFSA to reach a decision in its safety evaluation of already filed CBD novel food applications.⁴⁵ Only authorized novel foods are allowed to be placed on the market, and therefore the marketing of CBD is, at the time, not allowed anywhere in the European Union. However, not every Member State enforces the Novel Food Regulation in the same manner, leading to the situation that in some EU countries, like the Netherlands, CBD products may be found on the market.

The [European Industrial Hemp Association](https://eiha.org/) also works with a consortium on the novel food status of CBD in the European Union. The current novel food status of CBD may always be checked in the [EU Novel Food status catalogue](https://efsa.europa.eu/en/news/cannabidiol-novel-food-evaluations-hold-pending-new-data).

⁴⁴ For more information on EU Novel Food Regulation in general, see [E42024-0031 EU FAIRS Country Report Annual](https://www.efsa.europa.eu/en/news/cannabidiol-novel-food-evaluations-hold-pending-new-data)

⁴⁵ <https://www.efsa.europa.eu/en/news/cannabidiol-novel-food-evaluations-hold-pending-new-data>

Cosmetics

The use of hemp (extracts) and cannabidiol in cosmetics is permitted, as follows from the [EU Cosmetic Regulation 1223/2009](#). As topical, the ingredient receives much media coverage, for instance through popular beauty news media in the Netherlands. The Dutch Cosmetics Association estimates that the Dutch, in general, spent \$3.1 billion on cosmetics in 2023,⁴⁶ and the market keeps growing (9.5 percent from 2022 to 2023).

Hemp Textile

Textile made of hemp is a small sector in Europe. The organization Textile Exchange estimates that the market share of hemp fabric was 0.26 percent of the global fiber market in 2022.⁴⁷ Nonetheless, hemp textile has valuable prospects geared towards environmentally conscious consumers. Dutch consumers are always on the lookout for more sustainable ways of living, increasingly valuing how and where their textiles are made – favoring recycled materials in fabrics, and interested in the story of bio-based textiles. The growing popularity of fairs such as [Material District](#) (held annually in Utrecht, with almost 6,000 visitors and 150 exhibitors) are a telltale sign of this. There are a few small Dutch apparel brands that have dedicated themselves to hemp textiles, although hemp is still considered a niche market.⁴⁸

The [Dutch Circular Textile](#) plan refers to stimulating bio-based alternatives for textiles, and the Ministry of Infrastructure and Water Management is actively researching this option, using lessons learned from the National Approach Biobased Building. The European Union in its turn, is also stimulating bio-based textiles through its Circular Economy Action Plan, supporting different projects.⁴⁹ One of those projects is taking place in the Netherlands, and is called Hemp4Circularity and will run from 2023-2026.⁵⁰ It aims to strengthen the “circular value chain of hemp as a high-value textile material”. It is doing so by building on the expertise and processing capacity of the (already existing) flax processing and textile industry in Belgium, Germany, France, and the Netherlands.

Hemp Leaves, Animal Bedding, and Feed

Hemp as food also extends to hemp leaves, that are used for teas, and which may be freely marketed in the Netherlands.⁵¹ The husk of hemp is excellent for animal bedding, and Dutch companies are important players for this product. Hemp is recognized as feed material, and in the Netherlands specifically, hemp seed husks are registered for this purpose in the Animal Feed Register.⁵² In the

⁴⁶ <https://www.ncv-cosmetica.nl/cosmetica/omzet-en-werkgelegenheid/omzet-op-nederlandse-markt/>

⁴⁷ <https://www.cbi.eu/market-information/apparel/hemp-apparel/market-potential>

⁴⁸ See <https://www.cbi.eu/market-information/apparel/hemp-apparel/market-potential>

⁴⁹ See <https://build-up.ec.europa.eu/en/resources-and-tools/articles/circular-construction-and-materials-sustainable-building-sector>

⁵⁰ <https://hemp4circularity.nweurope.eu/>

⁵¹ <https://eiha.org/wp-content/uploads/2023/06/PR-hemp-leaves-as-traditional-food-EIHA-eV.pdf>

⁵² <https://www.feedmaterialsregister.eu/register>

Catalogue of feed materials ([EU Commission Regulation 68/2013](#)), hemp seed, hemp seed oil, hemp flour, hemp protein, hemp fiber, hemp expeller are authorized as feed material.⁵³

6. Strengths and Challenges

In summary, the Dutch hemp sector represents a strong and resilient sector, with years of expertise and knowledge. The outlook for the sector is that it can build on its many strengths, while approaching a few challenges (Table 1).

Table 1. Strengths and Challenges of the Dutch Hemp Sector

Strengths	Challenges
<i>Hemp cultivars, like in the US, may be grown if they contain less than 0.3 percent THC, creating trade opportunities in the seed sector and for raw/processed hemp between the two countries</i>	<i>To reach its isolation goals, the Netherlands would require approx. 50,000 hectares of land by 2030, with uncertainty if this amount of land is available for fiber crops,⁵⁴ due to constraints such as land availability</i>
<i>The Netherlands, also within the framework of the European Union, is looking to grow its biobased construction material market, which could lead to a strengthening of the whole Dutch value chain</i>	<i>CBD keep its novel food status for now; until market authorization (which may experience delays), CBD products cannot be marketed in the European Union</i>
<i>Hemp extracts and CBD are allowed, and in popular demand, in cosmetics in the EU. From the Netherlands, 170 million consumers can be reached within a 500-kilometer radius</i>	<i>In comparison to other crops, the hemp sector is relatively small, losing out on opportunities that scaled-up sectors might experience</i>
<i>Hemp is a very versatile product, that can almost fully be valorized, presenting an excellent marketing opportunity for its end products as a sustainable and durable choice or alternative</i>	<i>The sustainability and versality of hemp is receiving more attention, but is not always readily known to Dutch consumers. However, by bringing Dutch consumers in contact with hemp materials, such as by subsidizing homeowners to use hemp as natural insulation, awareness is increasing</i>
<i>The hemp textile sector may receive impulses through national & EU-subsidized projects, also in countries bordering the Netherlands (Belgium, France, Germany)⁵⁵; and even the Nordics⁵⁶</i>	

Appendix

Table 2. Total Dutch Imports from Trade Partners - Hemp Seeds, whether or not broken (excluding for sowing) (HS code: 12079991)

HS 12079991	2020	2021	2022	2023
World Total	\$15,711,572	\$20,310,124	\$17,256,118	\$8,816,300
1. France	\$2,192,172	\$1,958,906	\$1,377,641	\$2,969,642
2. China	\$6,972,684	\$6,214,369	\$5,832,503	\$2,815,472

⁵³ For more information on its regulatory requirements please see [E42022-0052 Market Trends and Regulation for Industrial Hemp in the European Union report](#).

⁵⁴ https://www.abnamro.nl/nl/media/rapport-vezelrijke-verduurzaming_tcml6-203727.pdf, p. 9-11.

⁵⁵ E.g., Hemp4Circularity: <https://hemp4circularity.nweurope.eu/>

⁵⁶ E.g., in Denmark: <https://bce.au.dk/en/currently/news/show/artikel/translate-to-english-fra-danske-hampemarkertil-baeredygtige-tekstiler/>

3. Canada	\$1,484,675	\$2,122,303	\$2,048,623	\$472,771
4. Romania	\$713,756	\$2,061,675	\$1,309,453	\$493,508
5. Germany	\$247,272	\$0	\$679,079	\$330,130
6. Belgium	\$565,527	\$0	\$781,385	\$414,714
7. Lithuania	\$59,611	\$284,527	\$436,094	\$6,821
8. Russia	\$0	\$0	\$119,768	\$206,122
9. Estonia	\$268,558	\$379,647	\$1,318,678	\$645,509
10. Denmark	\$3,036	\$1,765	\$7,019	\$2,561
32. United States	\$0	\$23,155	\$0	\$21
U.S. Share of Total	0%	0.1%	0%	0%

Table 3. Total Dutch Exports to Trade Partners - Hemp Seeds, whether or not broken (excluding for sowing) (HS code: 12079991)

HS 12079991	2020	2021	2022	2023
World Total	\$27,270,620	\$20,353,299	\$22,921,208	\$17,621,883
1. Germany	\$4,734,211	\$4,896,279	\$3,201,334	\$3,266,357
2. UK	\$2,782,261	\$2,134,480	\$2,195,479	\$2,326,350
3. Spain	\$3,605,183	\$2,175,754	\$3,994,097	\$2,273,925
4. Belgium	\$1,653,523	\$1,926,476	\$1,585,405	\$1,591,331
5. Italy	\$1,598,321	\$934,695	\$1,351,241	\$1,418,957
6. Romania	\$2,756,651	\$2,493,048	\$2,071,589	\$1,143,042
7. Austria	\$1,114,775	\$469,101	\$977,831	\$837,366
8. France	\$1,035,374	\$574,210	\$1,191,458	\$776,031
9. Czechia	\$1,301,211	\$620,148	\$772,909	\$718,537
10. Poland	\$1,416,090	\$717,974	\$1,163,002	\$712,868
44. United States	\$17,633	\$14,351	\$505,358	\$0
U.S. Share of Total	0.06%	0.07%	2.20%	0%

Attachments:

No Attachments.